

The Approval Router

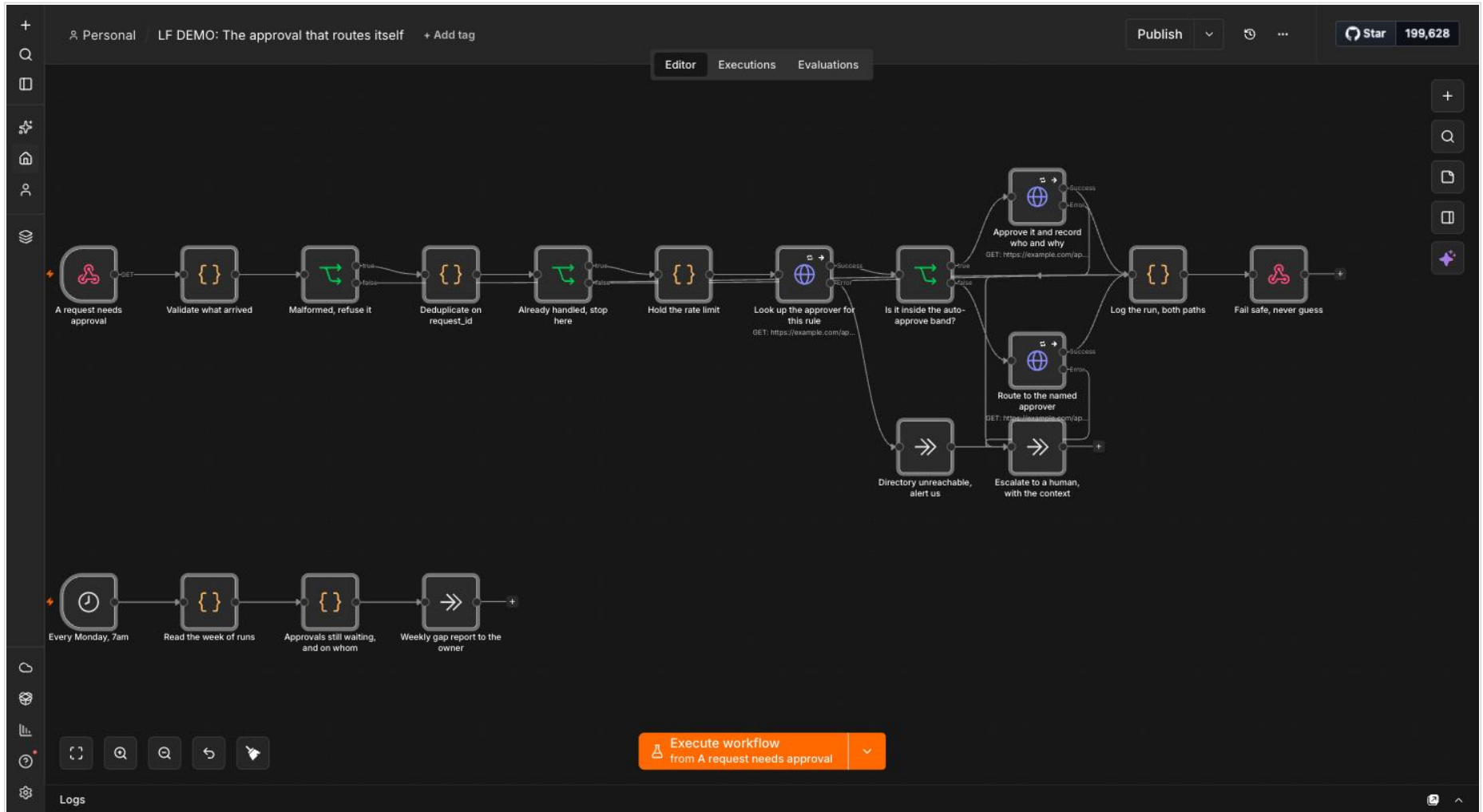
approval-routing · built in airtable

Approvals sit in an inbox with no ladder, so the bottleneck is invisible until someone asks why nothing shipped.

What it connects to: The request arrives in one place and the authority to approve lives in another. The audit trail has to span both or the band is unauditale.

1 of 4 SYSTEM

Here's the router: auto-approve inside a band, route the rest by rule, escalate on silence.



2 of 4 THINKING

Every auto-approval records who and why, or the band becomes unauditale.

The screenshot shows a workflow editor interface for a node titled "Is it inside the auto-approve band?". The interface is divided into three main sections: INPUT, Parameters, and OUTPUT.

INPUT Section: Displays "No input data" with a button "Execute previous nodes" and the text "to view input data".

Parameters Section: Contains tabs for "Parameters" and "Settings". Under "Parameters", there is a "Conditions" section with a JSON expression: `{{ $json.withinBand === true && $json.approver != null && $json.amount > 0 }}`. A dropdown menu shows "is true". Below the conditions is a toggle switch for "Convert types where required" (currently off) and an "Options" section with a "+ Add option" button. A prominent orange button "Execute step" is located at the top right of the Parameters section.

OUTPUT Section: Displays "No output data" with a button "Execute step" and the text "to view output data".

At the bottom of the Parameters section, there is a text input field with the placeholder "I wish this node would...".

3 of 4 THEIR-WORLD

The stage and approval configuration inside a real CRM.

SAMPLE - Cleaner Performance System

DataAutomationsInterfacesForms

All changes savedLaunchShare

AutomationsOFF2 - Manager approval sets Co...

Create new...Find an automation

1 - New complaint routes to review queue
When a record is created, update a recordOFF

2 - Manager approval sets Counts against s...
When a record is updated, update a recordOFF

TRIGGER

When a record is updated
Manager approved

ACTIONS

If Manager approved is ✓
Update a record

Update record
Excused?

+ Add condition

Test step

Properties

ACTION DETAILS

Action type
Update record

Update specific fields, or apply a template to a record.
Choose which record to update by selecting its table and record ID.

LABELS

Description
Enter a description

CONFIGURATION

Action will run...
If Manager approved is ✓

* Table
Incidents

* Record ID
ID of the record to update. To update a record from a previous step, use the + menu to choose the step and its Record ID. Must correspond to the selected table.
Airtable record ID

* Fields
Excused?
Counts against score

+ Choose field

And the weekly report naming who's actually holding things up.

SAMPLE - Cleaner Performance System

DATA

Automations

Interfaces

Forms

Launch

Share

Cleaners

Clients

Incidents

+ Add or import

Tools

Grid view

Hide fields

Filter

Group

Sort

Color

Team

Share and sync

+ Create new...

Find a view

Grid view

Incident ID	Status
1	1
2	2
3	3
+	

3 records

Sum 6

Excused?

Single select

Select one predefined option from a list, or prefill each new cell with a default option.

Options

Color-code options

Alphabetize

Unreviewed

Excused

Counts against score

Add option

Default

Unreviewed

+ Add description

Cancel

Save

Automate this field with an agent

Convert